

International Conference on Low Temperature Plasmas (ICLTP)

Constitution:

1. Introduction

The International Conference on Low Temperature Plasmas (ICLTP) is an annual scientific conference, that covers all aspects of low temperature plasma science. It is a yearly meeting of the Chinese Society of Theoretical and Applied Mechanics (CSTAM). The nature of the ICLTP and of the relationship between the ICLTP and CSTAM is defined entirely by the ICLTP Constitution.

The ICLTP is a non-exclusive meeting, governed exclusively by its members, as defined in section 2. It is open to all scientists around the world independent of nationality, race, and political orientation.

This document provides for the continuity of the Conference through provisions for the selection of Conference venues and dates, officers, duties of officers, filling of vacancies in offices, scheduling of meetings, selection of the presentation of papers and publication of abstracts, etc.

2. Membership

All registered attendees of one or more of the three most recent ICLTPs and additional individuals appointed by the ICLTP Executive Committee are members of ICLTP. The Executive Committee may cancel the membership of individuals by majority vote.

3. Meetings

The ICLTP convenes annually as a scientific meeting. The location and time of each meeting are determined at least two years before the respective conference by the Executive Committee by documented majority vote based on proposals presented to the Executive Committee by ICLTP members. Such proposals must include details on the venue including its size, location, and costs as well as a nomination of the Local Organizing Committee (LOC) Chair for the respective conference. By approving a given proposal, the proposed LOC Chair automatically becomes an appointed member of the Executive Committee. To maintain the international and non-exclusive character of the ICLTP, it should not be held in the same country in three consecutive years. The Executive Committee shall ensure holding the ICLTP in different regions of the world so that the entire low temperature plasma science community has equal opportunities to attend it.

During each Annual Conference a Business Meeting shall be held at which the Executive Committee Chair and Treasurer shall report on the technical and financial well-being of the Conference. Formal actions of the Conference shall be confirmed during this session by majority vote of registered members of the Conference present and voting, without specification of a quorum. At the Business Meeting new members of the Executive Committee are elected by majority vote by and based on nominations made by registered ICLTP members from the floor at the Business Meeting. Each year a minimum of 4 and a maximum of 6 new Executive Committee members are elected in this way. The number of new Executive Committee members will be selected to ensure a total of 18 active elected Executive Committee members in each year.

The Executive Committee will meet at least twice per year, once during the ICLTP (after the Business Meeting) and once prior to the Annual Meeting as the Abstract Selection Meeting (ASM). The ASM shall be held after the abstract deadline for the upcoming Annual Meeting and in a timely fashion to meet the deadlines for publication of the program. The time and location of the ASM will be chosen by the LOC Chair with approval of the Executive Committee. At the ASM, the Executive Committee will formally organize sessions for the upcoming Annual Meeting, accept or reject abstracts and see to other organizational matters as required.

4. Committees

The continuing business of the Conference is conducted by the Executive Committee. In addition, a Local Committee is formed by the LOC Chair to assist him or her in the conduct of the Conference. Finally, a senior advisory committee may be formed.

The Executive Committee exclusively makes all financial decisions based on documented majority vote of its members. All Executive Committee members are voting members. The Executive Committee, by documented majority vote of its members, selects the location, time, and nature of future conferences, including further definition of subject matter and scope of the conferences, including the abstract sorting categories. The Executive Committee selects invited speakers, based on nominations made by its members and all other ICLTP members, selects abstracts, generates the conference scientific program, sets the ICLTP registration fees and all deadlines, selects sponsors of the conference and makes all other decisions which must be made in the interval between conferences, including appointing ad hoc committees as may be required. Such decisions can be made based on proposals of the LOC.

The Executive Committee consists of eighteen (18) elected members and up to four (4) appointed members, appointed by the Executive Committee Chair. Its members shall be selected in such a way that they represent the global ICLTP community with respect to geographic locations and scientific topics. In its foundation year (2025), all Executive Committee members are appointed by the Executive Committee Chair in the absence of a Business Meeting. Their term of office will be determined individually by the Executive Committee Chair. In all other years, 4 - 6 new members of the Executive Committee are elected at the Business Meeting. The term of office of elected Executive Committee members is four years and the term of office of appointed Executive Committee members is 1 year. The term starts after the Business Meeting at which the new member was elected/appointed, and ends before the Executive Committee meeting held during the conference in the years of term expiration. The term of office of an elected Executive Committee member will be extended, if he or she is elected to become an ICLTP officer. A designated LOC Chair, appointed to the Executive Committee by its Chair based on approval of his or her proposal of a future ICLTP, must be elected as an Executive Committee member at the Business Meeting following his or her appointment. In this way the ICLTP members approve the corresponding proposal for a future ICLTP. If this individual is not elected at the Business Meeting, the Executive Committee needs to modify the plans for this future conference.

The Executive Committee members are: Executive Committee Chair, Executive Committee Chair-Elect or Executive Committee Past-Chair, LOC Chair, LOC Chair-Elect, LOC Past-Chair, Treasurer, four elected General Members, and up to 4 appointed members.

From among its members and by documented majority vote, the Executive Committee elects the following ILTPC officers:

- (i) An Executive Committee Chair-Elect is elected each odd-numbered year and serves a four-year term; a one-year term as Chair-Elect, then a two-year term as Chair, then a one-year term as Past-Chair.
- (ii) A LOC Chair-Elect is elected each year and serves a three-year term; a one-year term as LOC Chair-Elect, then a one-year term as LOC Chair, then a one-year term as Past-LOC Chair.
- (iii) The Treasurer is elected on even-numbered years and serves a two-year term starting from the day of his or her election.

The Past-Executive Committee Chair and the Past-LOC Chair must not be elected as the same ICLTP officer within two years after their period of office expired. The Treasurer may serve two consecutive terms, not to exceed four years total as Treasurer.

The presence of a majority of the voting Executive Committee members shall constitute a quorum. A committee member not able to attend a meeting in person, may attend a meeting electronically when the Executive Committee Chair judges such attendance is appropriate. Alternatively, a member who cannot be present at a particular committee meeting may be represented at that meeting by an alternate for that meeting, subject to the approval of the Executive Committee Chair.

Members of the senior advisory committee are appointed by the Executive Committee Chair. Their term of office is 4 years. They are not members of the Executive Committee, but provide non-binding advice to the Executive and Local Organizing Committees. They also actively contribute to invited speaker nominations and marketing of the conference.

5. Duties of ICLTP Executive Committee Members

All ICLTP Executive Committee Members must attend the yearly conference and contribute to it scientifically by making scientific presentations, either held by themselves or members of their research group with them as co-authors. They must nominate and recruit invited speakers for the ICLTP.

- (i) Executive Committee Chair: The Executive Committee Chair shall preside at all meetings of the Executive Committee. The Executive Committee Chair shall represent the Conference externally and shall perform such other functions as may be explicitly provided in the Constitution or mandated by the Executive Committee. The Executive Committee Chair shall preside at the Business Meeting. The Executive Committee Chair shall retain a current version of the Constitution, assure conformance to their provisions, and give a copy to each new member of the Executive Committee.
- (ii) Executive Committee Chair-Elect: In years when the ICLTP has an Executive Committee Chair-Elect, the Executive Committee Chair-Elect shall act in place of the Executive Committee Chair if the latter is unable to perform his or her duties. The Executive Committee Chair-Elect shall perform such other functions as may be requested by the Executive Committee Chair.

- (iii) Executive Committee Past-Chair. In years when the ICLTP has an Executive Committee Past-Chair, the Executive Committee Past-Chair shall act in place of the Executive Committee Chair if the latter is unable to perform his or her duties. The Executive Committee Past-chair shall perform such other functions as may be requested by the Executive Committee Chair.
- (iv) Local Organizing Committee Chair: The LOC Chair shall serve as the principal administrator of the Conference held during his or her term. The LOC Chair shall make arrangements for that year's Conference, supervise the Local Conference Committee and staff and notify members of the time, place, and program for the upcoming conference. Such tasks include making a contract with the venue at least one year prior to the conference, selecting session rooms and AV equipment, organizing meals and social events, forming award / travel grant committees that select award / travel grant winners, updating the ICLTP website, abstract submission and registration platforms, recruiting sponsors, and preparing / sending out conference announcements on time. All related actions must be approved by the Executive Committee represented by its Chair. The LOC Chair shall maintain the records of that year's Conference - including minutes of the Business and Executive Committee meetings. He or she shall insure that liability insurance is in force in the amount set by the Executive Committee. The LOC Chair shall maintain financial records of the Conference held during his or her term, jointly with the Treasurer. The LOC Chair shall conform to the policies set forth by the Executive Committee governing the expenditure of Conference funds by the Local Committee. The LOC Chair may request and receive funds from the Treasurer prior to the Conference in order to meet obligations. The LOC Chair shall establish financial accounts for that year's Conference. Within six months following the Conference he or she, as the Past-LOC Chair, shall make an accounting to the Treasurer on how the registration fee and other funds received were used. The Executive Committee, by documented majority vote, will decide how to handle any potential surplus or deficit of a yearly conference. The LOC Chair must follow the correspondig decision of the Executive Committee. The LOC Chair shall perform such other duties as the Executive Committee may assign.
- (v) LOC Chair-Elect: The LOC Chair-Elect shall act in place of the LOC Chair if the latter is unable to perform his or her duties. The LOC Chair-Elect is responsible for publicity of the Conference held during his or her term. The LOC Chair-Elect shall petition the ICLTP Executive Committee to approve the next year's Conference (the one in which he or she will act as LOC Chair. The LOC Chair-Elect shall perform such other duties as the Executive Committee may assign.
- (vi) LOC Past-Chair: The LOC Past-Chair shall assist with the duties of the LOC Chair if the latter is unable to perform his or her duties. The LOC Past-Chair shall update the Operations Procedure Manual for the Conference based on material produced and experience gained during his or her term as LOC Chair and send a copy to both the LOC Chair and the Executive Committee Chair. He or she shall prepare a final financial report for the Conference held during his or her term as LOC Chair and present it to the Treasurer no later than six months following that Conference. The LOC Past-Chair shall fulfill all obligations to government and corporate sponsors of the Conference held during his or her term as LOC Chair. The LOC Past-Chair shall perform such other duties as the Executive Committee Chair may assign.

- (vii) **Treasurer:** The Treasurer is responsible for the funds of the Conference and reports annually on receipts, and expenditures during the past year, and on current accounts balances (in writing to the Executive Committee, and verbally at the Business and Executive Committee meetings). The funds of the Conference shall be deposited in the name of the Conference in an account at financial institutions approved by the Executive Committee. All transactions must be approved by the Executive Committee represented by its Chair. Checks and other documents shall be signed, endorsed, or otherwise authorized on behalf of the Conference by the Treasurer or other persons designated by the Executive Committee.
- (viii) **General Elected and Appointed Members of the Executive Committee:** The General Members of the Executive Committee shall attend and participate in all meetings of the Executive Committee unless excused by the Chair, and shall carry out the work of the Committee.

6. Filling of Vacancies

If a vacancy occurs in the position of Executive Committee Chair or the Executive Committee Chair is unable to perform his or her duties, the Executive Committee Chair-Elect (if any) shall succeed and shall complete the term as well as his or her own term. If a vacancy occurs in the position of Executive Committee Chair or the Executive Committee Chair is unable to perform his or her duties during a year when there is no Executive Committee Chair-Elect, the Executive Committee Past-Chair shall succeed and shall complete the term.

If a vacancy occurs in any office other than Executive Committee Chair, the Executive Committee shall appoint someone to complete the term.

If a vacancy occurs in the General Members of the Executive committee, the Executive Committee may appoint someone to fill the position until the next meeting of the Executive Committee. At that time, the Executive Committee shall elect a person to complete the term if at that time the term has not expired.

7. Establishment or Amendment of Constitution

The Constitution may be established or amended by the following procedure. A new Constitution or amendment may be introduced by submitting it in writing to the Executive Committee Chair if endorsed by signatures of fifteen ICLTP members and received by the Executive Committee Chair before the deadline for submission of abstracts for that annual Conference. The Executive Committee Chair shall include the proposed amendments in the final announcement of that Conference and the Executive Committee Chair shall present it to the members at the Business Meeting for consideration. An affirmative vote of two-thirds of the members present at the Business Meeting shall serve to adopt the new Constitution or amendment.

8. Compensation

The officers and other members of the Executive Committee shall not be compensated financially for their time, but out-of-pocket expenses incurred by them on account of attendance at committee meetings may be paid by the Conference at the discretion of the Executive Committee Chair. This may include, but not exceed, reasonable travel and local expenses.

9. Removal of Officers

An officer can be removed from office for noncompliance to the rules laid out in the Constitution by unanimous save one vote by the Executive Committee. A petition for removal endorsed by ten ICLTP members may be introduced by submitting it in writing to the Executive Committee Chair. The Executive Committee Chair shall then send a copy of it to each member of the Executive Committee along with a secret ballot. The office shall be filled by the normal procedure for Filling of Vacancies.

10. Relationship of the ICLTP with the Chinese Society of Theoretical and Applied Mechanics

The ICLTP will be a CSTAM scientific conference. All decisions regarding the ILTPC are made exclusively by the ICLTP Executive Committee. This includes, among others, all decisions on finances, conference locations, dates, and format. The CSTAM will, promote and monitor the conference as well as provide optional advice.